STRATEGY · FOUNDER'S OFFICE

Bhagavad Gita Daily.

Monetization & Growth Strategy

From a 2.2% funnel to a ₹1 Lakh MRR engine.

DIVYAMAN PAL

B.Tech, Civil Engineering · IIT Kanpur

divyamp23@iitk.ac.in

PREPARED FOR

Glido Labs

Strategy Assignment · Confidential

192K Instagram followers	**2.2%** Visitor → Paid today	**₹9.2K** Current MRR
8–12% Industry conversion	**₹1L+** MRR target (90d)	**5x** Revenue upside, no new traffic

THE THESIS

Not a product problem. Not an audience problem.
A funnel problem and a monetization-depth problem — both fixable in 90 days.

May 2025 · Strategy Deck v1.0

SETTING THE LENS

Why this brand can win — before we touch the funnel

Three structural advantages most subscription startups would pay millions to acquire.

01

An audience that already trusts you

192K followers built on devotion, not dopamine. Trust-based audiences convert 3–5x better than entertainment-based ones — when the funnel matches their psychology.

02

A product that works

116 paying users at ₹79/month, sticking. The retention curve has flattened — proof of product-market fit. The job now is not to invent; it is to amplify.

03

A category with no dominant brand

There is a Sadhguru, a Gaur Gopal, a Jay Shetty. There is no daily, intimate, ₹79/month ritual. The 'morning shlok' habit can become this brand's blue-ocean.

Strategic implication: the moat here is psychological, not technological. Defending it requires intimacy, ritual and consistency — not features.

EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

The 5-minute version of this deck

What is true today

Bhagavad Gita Daily converts only 2.2% of website visitors into paid subscribers, against an industry benchmark of 8–12% for spiritual & wellness subscriptions at this price point. Closing half that gap delivers 4–5x current revenue with zero new traffic.

The brand has the rarest assets in consumer subscription — a loyal, spiritually-engaged audience, a working product, and a live payment funnel. What it does not have is a funnel that respects its user, and a monetization stack that reflects what the audience is willing to pay for.

₹1 Lakh MRR target by Month 3 — achievable if Lever 01 lands in the first 30 days.

THE THREE LEVERS

01 Seal the funnel

Stop the bleed at homepage, trial and Day-3 churn. Zero new spend.

02 Scale top-of-funnel

DM automation → content engine → paid acquisition. In that order.

03 Deepen monetization

Annual, PDF guides, premium community, card deck, B2B.

The funnel today: three leaks, one fix-order

Each row shows where the funnel is, where the industry sits, and which leak to fix first.

Stage	Today	Conv. now	Benchmark	Status
Instagram → Website	192K followers	**~2.7%**	5–8%	CRITICAL
Homepage → Form visit	5,239 → 952	**18.2%**	35–45%	CRITICAL
Form visit → Trial	952 → 163	**17.1%**	40–55%	CRITICAL
Trial → Paid	163 → 116	**71.2%**	80–90%	IMPROVE
Paid → Retained (30-day)	116 active / 47 churned	**71.2%**	85–92%	IMPROVE

Diagnosis: 88% of every leak sits in steps 2 and 3. Fix those first; they are free, fast and compounding.

Who actually subscribes — The Modern Seeker

THE MODERN SEEKER

Aged 32–55 · Tier 1 / 2 cities

Hindi-first or bilingual. Spiritually inclined but time-poor. Curious about Gita, intimidated by it. Shops on UPI, lives on WhatsApp, gifts on festivals.

JOBS-TO-BE-DONE

- Anchor my morning with meaning
- Make sense of life events through tradition
- Feel connected to something larger — daily
- Pass the wisdom to my kids and parents

ANXIETIES THAT KILL CONVERSION

- ₹5 mandate — "will they keep deducting?"
- UPI auto-pay distrust in tier 2/3 cohorts
- "Is this just another spiritual reels page?"
- Forgetting they signed up → angry chargebacks

WHAT MAKES THEM PAY

- Sample message that feels personally written
- A friend forwarded it on WhatsApp
- A real face / scholar attached to the brand
- Festival or life-event trigger (Navratri, exam)

WHAT MAKES THEM STAY

- Same time, every morning — without fail
- The verse "happens to" speak to today
- Felt sense of a teacher, not a bot
- Community of people on the same path

The Trust Equation — why spiritual subscriptions break differently

Most SaaS funnels optimize for friction. Spiritual products must optimize for trust. We adapt the classic Trust Equation:

TRUST =

(Credibility + Reliability + Intimacy) ÷ Self-Orientation

(adapted from Maister-Green-Galford for consumer spiritual products)

CREDIBILITY

Who is the teacher?

Add a real founder/scholar face on homepage and WhatsApp. Replace generic tagline with a specific promise.

RELIABILITY

Does it arrive every day?

8 AM delivery non-negotiable. Day 3 charge announced 24h before. Status messages even on holidays.

INTIMACY

Does it feel like it knows me?

Persona-poll → personalized first verse. Day-1 welcome that names the journey, not the transaction.

SELF-ORIENTATION

Does it feel like a sale?

Kill competing CTAs. "Cancel anytime — reply STOP". Re-engagement with no discount, just the product.

Three leaks. Three different root causes.

LEAK 01

Homepage → Form

82% drop

ROOT CAUSE

Page is doing too much. Subscribe, browse, learn — all competing.

THE FIX

Single-purpose page. Form above fold. One CTA. Specific hero promise. Sample message preview.

LEAK 02

Form → Trial

83% drop

ROOT CAUSE

₹5 UPI mandate scares spiritually-motivated tier-2/3 users.

THE FIX

Bilingual mandate explainer. Trust badges. Test removing mandate entirely. Instant WhatsApp welcome.

LEAK 03

Trial → Paid

47 churned (~29%)

ROOT CAUSE

Day-3 charge surprises users — too little value experienced in 3 days.

THE FIX

Day 1/2/3 WhatsApp sequence. Pre-charge transparency. 48h re-engagement for cancels.

Leak 01 — Make the homepage do one job

TODAY · Why it leaks

- Hero tagline is generic — "Ancient Wisdom, Timeless Truth" tells the user nothing
- Competing CTAs: Explore Chapters, Explore Teachings, Start Learning
- Social proof contradicts itself: "4,000+" vs "12,000+" on the same page
- Form lives below the fold — avg scroll depth only 51.95%
- LCP at 3.9s on mobile · 129 sessions hit "undefined is not an object"
- Free Gita resources are a reason NOT to pay

AFTER · Single-purpose conversion page

- Hero: "One shlok from the Gita, every morning on WhatsApp — explained for your life today."
- One CTA: subscribe form above the fold on mobile
- Visible WhatsApp message mock-up next to the CTA
- One social proof number, used everywhere
- Compress hero image · target LCP < 2.5s · resolve JS errors
- Move "Explore Chapters" to a post-subscribe experience

Expected impact: Homepage → Form lifts from 18% → 30%+ in 30 days. Zero new ad spend.

Leak 02 / 03 — A trial that earns the ₹79 charge

The fix is a 3-day WhatsApp activation arc — value experienced before money is moved.

Sign-up	Day 1	Day 2	Day 3	Cancel?
1	2	3	4	5
T = 0	**8 AM**	**8 AM + 7 PM**	**Pre-charge**	**T + 48h**
Instant WhatsApp welcome — "Your Gita journey starts tomorrow at 8 AM — here's today's shlok 🙏"	First shlok + permission to explore. "For the next 3 days, this is completely free."	Shlok at 8 AM + evening preview of the next 5 shlokas. Annual upsell teaser appears here.	"Your trial ends today. ₹79 will be charged at [time]. Reply STOP to cancel."	Single re-engagement WhatsApp: today's shlok + "Your spot is still here." 15–20% return.

Checkout fixes that compound: bilingual mandate explainer · Razorpay/UPI logo · "Cancel anytime" badge · one real testimonial.

From 2–3 trials/day to 25 — the math, then the plan

THE MATH

25 trials/day ÷ 17% form-to-trial = ~150 form visits/day → vs ~16 today = 9× ToFu lift required.

PHASE 01

Weeks 1–4

DM automation

ManyChat trigger on 'GITA' comment auto-DMs the form. Story CTA daily. One 15-min Instagram Live/week.

EXPECTED IMPACT

30–45% comment→form vs 1–2% bio link. 5× ToFu at zero spend.

PHASE 02

Weeks 5–12

Content-led growth

1 Reel/day · cross-post to Shorts · 4–6 micro-creator collabs · WhatsApp viral loop in every daily message.

EXPECTED IMPACT

Compounding organic. Adds the second 2–3× to ToFu without ads.

PHASE 03

Month 3+

Paid acquisition

Meta CTWA at ₹500/day · lookalike of paid subscribers · age 28–55, Hindi spiritual interests, T1+T2 cities.

EXPECTED IMPACT

Only after homepage→trial > 8%. Target CAC < ₹150, ROAS > 1.5×.

Closing the value gap between free and paid

Today, Instagram followers get the same content for free that subscribers pay for. Make the WhatsApp product feel exclusive — and Instagram a tease, not a substitute.

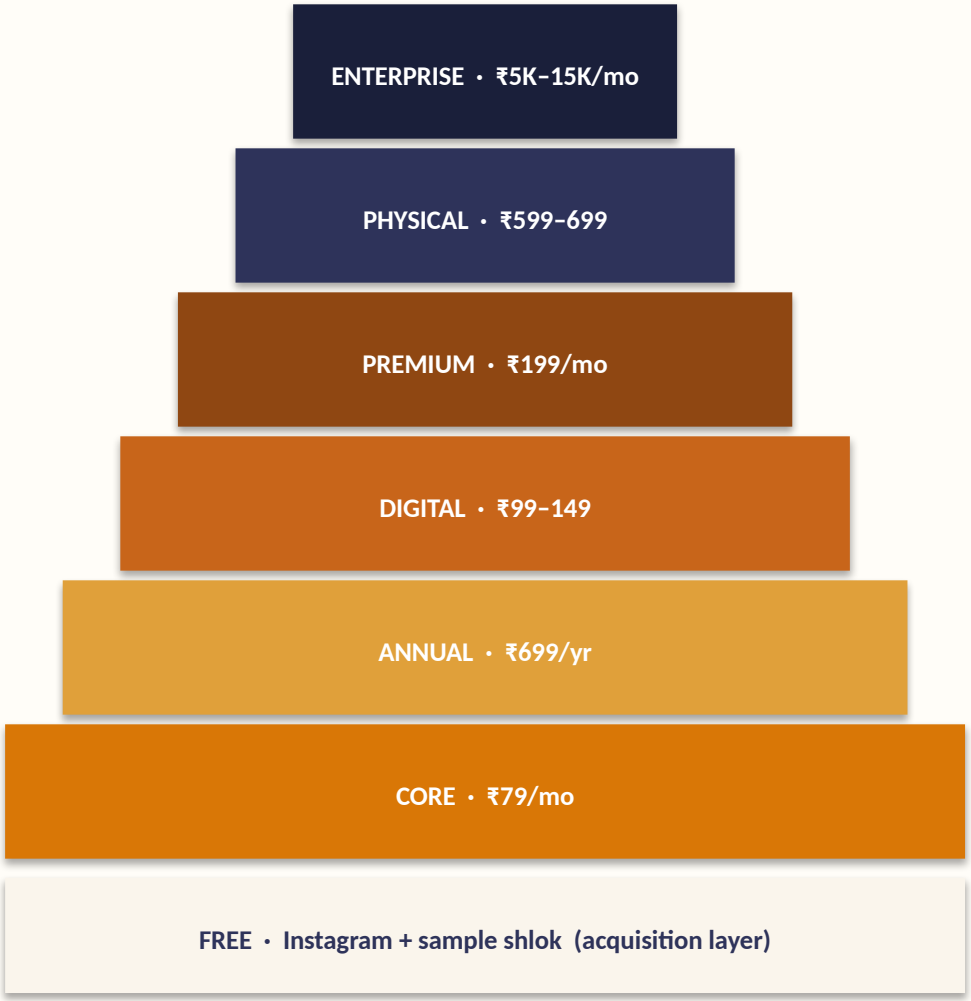
DIMENSION	FREE · Instagram	PAID · WhatsApp
Content depth	Shlok image / verse	**Shlok + meaning + life application**
Personalization	One-to-many caption	**Reflection tied to today's verse**
Cadence	Variable, algorithm-led	**8 AM, every morning. No exceptions.**
Relationship	Public broadcast	**Private, ritual, companion-like**
Discoverability	Anyone can find it	**A curated channel just for you**

Caption pattern that monetizes: "Today's shlok ☝️ | Full meaning + how to apply it to your life today → link in bio."

Five campaigns to test — ranked by expected impact

01	**What is Krishna saying about your life right now?** Story poll: career / relationships / overthinking / lost. Auto-DM relevant shlok + trial link.	EXPECTED IMPACT ★★★★★
02	**Subscriber Before & After Reels** 1-line testimonials from active 116. Format: situation → shlok → outcome. Native social proof.	EXPECTED IMPACT ★★★★☆
03	**"Gita for [situation]" series** Anxiety, exams, heartbreak, Monday morning, quitting. Shareable + searchable + trial driver.	EXPECTED IMPACT ★★★★☆
04	**200K Milestone unlock** First 200 to DM 'GITA200' get 1 month free. PR pitch: India's most-followed Gita page crosses 200K.	EXPECTED IMPACT ★★★☆☆
05	**Festival gifting (Navratri / Diwali / birthdays)** Dedicated gift sub page. Spiritual gifting is real and underserved. 100–200 subs/single push.	EXPECTED IMPACT ★★★★☆

From one ₹79 SKU to a full monetization stack



MONTHLY REVENUE AT SCALE

(post-Month 3 base case)

Core monthly · 800 subs × ₹79	**₹63,200**
Annual · 50 prepay × ₹699	**₹34,950**
Premium community · 100 × ₹199	**₹19,900**
PDF guides · 150 sales × ₹99	**₹14,850**
Card deck · 50 × ₹599 (gross)	**₹29,950**
Corporate · 3 clients @ avg ₹10K	**₹30,000**
Blended monthly revenue	**₹1.92L+**

Three revenue streams to launch first

Annual plan · ₹699/yr

Reduces 12-month churn to ~0%. Cash flow upfront.

- Pitch on Day-2 of trial via WhatsApp
- "Save ₹249 vs monthly" — anchored, not discounted
- 15–20% take rate of new subscribers
- 120–160 plans/month → ₹84K–₹1.1L upfront

GO-LIVE

Month 1

Situation PDF guides · ₹99–149

Anxiety · Career · Relationships · Students · Grief.

- Built from 2,227 existing posts — zero CMS cost
- Sell via Story link sticker + WhatsApp broadcast
- Bundle of 5 at ₹399 to anchor value
- 150 sales/month → ₹14K+ at ~100% margin

GO-LIVE

Month 1

Premium community · ₹199/mo

Live Q&A, chapter deep-dives, scholar access.

- Capped at 100–150 — scarcity is the feature
- Upsold to subscribers at 3-month mark
- 8–12% take rate of paid base
- 64–96 members → ₹12.7K–₹19.1K/month

GO-LIVE

Month 3

Corporate Gita Daily — the asymmetric B2B bet

MARKET SIZING (illustrative)

TAM · Indian corporate wellness

₹4,000 Cr

Growing at 15% CAGR

SAM · Mid-size firms, traditional sectors

₹400 Cr

BFSI · FMCG · Manufacturing

SOM (Year 1) · Lighthouse pilots

₹50–80 L

10–15 anchor clients

Why now: HR teams in BFSI, FMCG and manufacturing are buying "mindfulness at work". A Gita-based programme is differentiated and culturally resonant — not another meditation app.

GO-TO-MARKET

Product	Daily WhatsApp/email shlok with workplace lens · monthly engagement report · optional quarterly scholar talk
Buyer	HR Heads at 500–5,000 employee firms in BFSI, FMCG, manufacturing
Pricing	₹5K (≤50) · ₹10K (50–200) · ₹15K (200+)
Motion	15-min LinkedIn outreach · pilot offer · case-study fly-wheel
Strategic	B2C credibility halo — every corporate logo is a B2B social proof asset

Competitive landscape — owning the daily-ritual quadrant

The defensible position: a daily, intimate, vernacular ritual at the price of a coffee. No incumbent owns it.

STRATEGY

What makes this defensible — three compounding loops

LOOP 01

Daily-habit moat

8 AM ritual

The morning shlok becomes a habit, like coffee. Habit-based products have the lowest churn in consumer subscription.

LOOP 02

Trust moat

Founder + scholar voice

A real teacher attached to the brand cannot be cloned by a content farm. Trust compounds with each retained subscriber.

LOOP 03

Data moat

Persona-poll signals

Every story poll feeds personalization data that lets the next subscriber be onboarded smarter than the last. AI-ready.

PIRATE-METRIC (AARRR) MAP

Acquisition	Activation	Retention	Referral	Revenue
DM automation	Day-1 WhatsApp	8 AM ritual	Forward-to-friend	Tiered stack

STRATEGY

Risk register — what can go wrong, and our pre-mortem

Risk	Impact	Likelihood	Mitigation
Mandate distrust spikes refund / chargeback rate	HIGH	MED	Bilingual mandate explainer · pre-charge transparency · easy STOP
Removing ₹5 mandate inflates trials but drops paid	MED	MED	A/B test by week. Hold-out cohort. Switch back if Trial→Paid <70%
Founder-led content fatigue	HIGH	LOW	Onboard 2 contributing scholars by Month 3. Brand > person.
Instagram algorithm dependency	HIGH	MED	Diversify to Shorts, ShareChat, Moj. Email backup of WhatsApp.
WhatsApp policy / compliance change	CRITICAL	LOW	Move to WhatsApp Business API + email mirror by Month 2.
Premium community quality dilution	MED	MED	Hard cap at 150. Founder + scholar moderation. Quarterly cull.

OPERATE

North-Star metric & weekly dashboard

NORTH-STAR METRIC

Daily Retained Reads — # of subscribers who opened today's WhatsApp shlok within 12 hours.

Captures product (read), retention (today), and value (the ritual). Beats raw MRR for early-stage steering.

Metric	Now	Day-30	Day-60	Day-90
Daily new trials	2–3	8–10	15–18	**20–30**
Homepage → Form rate	18.2%	30%	35%	**40%+**
Form → Trial rate	17.1%	30%	35%	**40%+**
Trial → Paid rate	71.2%	78%	82%	**88%+**
Monthly churn	~29%	<20%	<12%	**<8%**
Active paid subscribers	116	230	480	**800+**
Monthly MRR	₹9.2K	₹18K	₹38K	**₹63K+**
Blended monthly revenue	₹9.2K	₹22K	₹70K	**₹1.0L+**

OPERATE

90-day execution roadmap

Phase	Theme	Actions	Owner	Success metric
Week 1–2	**Fix the leak**	Redesign homepage fold · move form above fold · fix social proof contradiction · resolve JS errors · compress images · add mandate explainer.	Dev + Design	**Homepage → Form > 25%**
Week 2–3	**Seal the trial**	Deploy 3-day WhatsApp activation sequence (Day 1/2/3) · re-engagement flow for 47 churned users · pre-charge transparency message.	Product + Content	**Trial → Paid > 80%**
Week 3–4	**DM automation**	ManyChat 'GITA' trigger · update post captions · first Story poll campaign · daily Story CTA.	Growth	**Daily trials 8–10**
Month 2	**New revenue**	Launch annual plan · publish 3 PDF guides · gift-subscription page live in time for upcoming festival.	Product	**₹30K+ non-subscription revenue**
Month 3	**Scale content**	Daily Reels · 2 creator collabs · premium community waitlist · pitch first 3 corporate clients.	Content + Sales	**Daily trials 20–25**
Month 3+	**Paid acquisition**	Meta CTWA at ₹500/day · lookalike from subscriber list · weekly CAC review.	Growth	**CAC < ₹150 · ROAS > 1.5×**

THE BIG BET

Fix the funnel before you scale it.
Deepen monetization before you buy traffic.

Most spiritual subscriptions die buying ads into broken funnels. We will not. The 90-day plan is sequenced so the first ₹0 of new spend earns the right to the next ₹1 of paid acquisition.

WHAT WE WILL HAVE BY MONTH 3

Funnel	Homepage → Trial above 8%, Trial → Paid above 88%
Audience	800+ active paying subscribers (vs 116 today)
Revenue	₹1.0L+ blended MRR — 11× current
Stack	Annual, PDF guides, premium community live
Pipeline	3 corporate pilots in motion · paid ads live with positive ROAS
Brand	200K+ Instagram, first PR mention as India's daily Gita ritual

FROM THE GITA

"You have a right to perform your prescribed duty, but not to the fruits of action." — 2.47

Operating principle: ship the funnel; the MRR will follow.

Thank you.

Happy to walk through any section in detail.

DIVYAMAN PAL

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